

CBSE Class IX English Literature

Academic Report (Session 2026–27)

1. Chapter Analysis: *Winds of Change*

Overview & Etymology

The hand fan, or *Pankha*, is a profound symbol of Indian heritage that has successfully transitioned from a functional cooling tool to a revered cultural artifact. This transition mirrors the broader evolution of Indian craft, where utility and artistry converge to preserve regional identities.

- **Etymology:** The word *Pankha* is derived from *pankh*, meaning a bird's feather. Historically, the term *Pankhi* referred specifically to small, plumed fans used in ancient India.
- **Historical Background:** The legacy of the *Pankha* traces back to the 2nd century CE, evidenced in the Buddhist wall paintings of the Ajanta Caves. Beyond paintings, its presence is documented in ancient sculptures, intricate carvings, and traditional embroidery.
- **Scale and Utility:** Historically, fans exhibited immense variety in size—ranging from a tiny two-inch decorative piece to massive fans requiring a person's full arm strength to operate in royal settings.

Craftspeople & Communities

- **Industrious Home-based Women of Gujarat:** Specialize in mirror work and cross-stitch embroidery.
- **Tribal Communities:** Embed materials like grass and metal into fans using bamboo sticks. Silk and brass are reserved specifically for antique pieces, while contemporary designs often feature white ink on red backgrounds with geometrical patterns.

Regional Varieties of Indian Pankhas

Region / State	Type of Fan	Distinctive Materials	Unique Features
Rajasthan	Appliqué, Zardozi, Temple Fan	Fabric pieces, Gold/silver thread, Engraved brass	Ornamental needlework; glittering ornate encrusted threadwork; features long handles primarily used for fanning deities.
Gujarat	Mirror work, Beads, Kutch Leather	Pure cotton, Colourful beads, Hand-stitched leather	Reflective mirrors on cotton; silver handles for wall decoration; thread and wool accents at seams.
West Bengal	Sola, Tal Patar	Sola (water grass), Palm leaf	Sola fans are made from the milky-white spongy center of the plant; <i>Tal Patar Pankha</i> is a staple in local households.
Uttar Pradesh	Phadh	Gold zari, Silk, Satin	Adorned with pure gold, silver zari, and luxurious satin frills.
Odisha / Bihar	Palm Leaf, Bamboo	Large palm leaves, Bamboo	Recognized for antiquity and rarity; Bihar's versions are notably sturdy and colourful.
Tribal Regions	Geometrical	Grass, Metal, Bamboo	Features white ink on red backgrounds; silk and brass reserved for antique versions.

Themes & Historical Shift

- **Cultural Continuity:** The survival of ancient designs from Ajanta (2nd century CE) to modern homes.

- **Artistry in Everyday Objects:** The elevation of a simple cooling tool to an intricate work of art.
- **Economic Empowerment:** Government-led workshops and commercial platforms have transformed this personal handicraft into a source of sustainable livelihood for rural artisans.

Key Vocabulary

- **Indigenous:** Local; originating from a specific place.
- **Innovative:** New and original in approach.
- **Industrious:** Hardworking.
- **Intricate:** Elaborate and detailed.
- **Invoked:** Brought out or called upon.
- **Initiatives:** Actions taken to improve a situation.

2. Poem Analysis: *Canvas of Soil* by Maya Anthony

Overview

Maya Anthony's "*Canvas of Soil*" explores the synergy between human effort and nature. It elevates gardening from manual toil to a fine art, where the earth serves as the medium for creative expression.

Core Themes & Symbolism

- **Gardening as Fine Art:** The gardener is reimagined as a painter using a creative vision to shape the land.
- **Harmony and Diversity:** Blending colors symbolizes how diverse elements in life create a unified whole.
- **Life's Journey (Allegory):** The garden plot represents human potential; true growth requires intentionality, patience, and care.

Literary & Poetic Devices

- **Rhyme Scheme: AABB.** This structured form mirrors the intentional, planned, and orderly layout of a garden plot.
- **Metaphor:** Seeds are styled as "*brushstrokes*"; the earth functions as a "*palette*."
- **Personification:** Blossoms are depicted "*dancing in the morning light*," giving nature human agency.

- **Alliteration:** "*Blossoms bloom.*"
- **Dual Meaning of "Still":** In "*Gardens become paintings still*", the word "*still*" acts as both a noun (a tranquil, motionless image) and an adverb (persisting through time), emphasizing timeless beauty.

Significance of Colors

- **Green:** Vitality, foundation, and the "base coat" of the natural canvas.
- **Red:** Passion, warmth, energy, and the vibrant reward of patience.
- **Blue:** Tranquility, depth, and the serenity of natural elements.
- **Theoretical Yellow:** Represents sunlight and warmth; symbolically completes the primary palette needed to bring the canvas to life.

3. Consolidated Revision Sheet

Master Entity Table

Entity	Source Text	Key Traits & Roles
Home-based Women	<i>Winds of Change</i>	Industrious artisans preserving Gujarati embroidery and mirror work.
Tribal Artisans	<i>Winds of Change</i>	Creators of geometrical fans; reserve silk and brass for antique pieces.
The Gardener	<i>Canvas of Soil</i>	An artist who treats the soil as a canvas and seeds as brushstrokes.

Cause & Consequence Matrix

Action / Event	Consequence / Result
Arrival of modern electric fans and ACs	The <i>Pankha</i> shifts from a functional necessity to a decorative/ritualistic artifact.
Government initiatives & workshops organized	Cultural awareness increases; artisans gain sustainable commercial livelihoods.
Gardener tills the soil with intentionality	The garden becomes a living painting representing human potential.

High-Value Facts for Revision

1. *Pankha* origins date back to 2nd Century CE Buddhist wall paintings in the Ajanta Caves.

2. Historically, hand fans ranged from 2 inches in size to massive frames requiring full arm strength.
3. *Sola* fans are crafted from the milky-white spongy center of water grass in West Bengal.
4. Antique tribal fans are distinguished by their exclusive use of silk and brass.
5. The poem *Canvas of Soil* uses an **AABB** rhyme scheme to mirror an organized garden layout.
6. In *Canvas of Soil*, the word "*still*" functions with dual meaning: a motionless visual image and persistence over time.
7. The root word *pankh* means a bird's feather.
8. "*Invoked*" in the text translates to "*brought out*".

4. 15-Question Practice Question Bank

Standard Multiple-Choice Questions

1. **What does 'Pankhi' specifically refer to in the 2nd Century CE context?**
 - A) A large temple fan
 - B) A small plumed fan
 - C) A royal canopy
 - D) A type of feather
 - **Correct Answer: B**
2. **Which state is known for 'Phadh' fans adorned with gold zari and satin frills?**
 - A) Bihar
 - B) Rajasthan
 - C) Uttar Pradesh
 - D) West Bengal
 - **Correct Answer: C**
3. **In tribal fan-making, which materials are exclusively reserved for antique pieces?**
 - A) Bamboo and grass
 - B) Metal and white ink

- C) Silk and brass
- D) Cotton and mirror work
- **Correct Answer: C**

4. **What does the AABB rhyme scheme in 'Canvas of Soil' signify?**

- A) The chaos of nature
- B) The orderly, planned layout of a garden
- C) The passage of winter
- D) The gardener's exhaustion
- **Correct Answer: B**

5. **Why does the poet use the word 'wide' rather than 'long' to describe the garden canvas?**

- A) To fit the rhyme scheme
- B) To emphasize expansive potential and creative freedom
- C) To describe a geometric square plot
- D) To indicate physical distance
- **Correct Answer: B**

6. **Which color symbolizes vitality and the foundation in 'Canvas of Soil'?**

- A) Red
- B) Blue
- C) Green
- D) Yellow
- **Correct Answer: C**

7. **In 'Canvas of Soil', what are 'brushstrokes of seeds' a metaphor for?**

- A) Accidental growth
- B) Intentional artistic design
- C) Rainfall pattern
- D) Physical exhaustion

- **Correct Answer: B**

8. What is the etymological origin of the word 'Pankha'?

- A) Wind
- B) Feather (*pankh*)
- C) Hand
- D) Flower
- **Correct Answer: B**

9. Which state produces traditional fans made from the spongy center of 'sola' water grass?

- A) Odisha
- B) Bihar
- C) West Bengal
- D) Rajasthan
- **Correct Answer: C**

10. What is the meaning of the word 'Invoked' as used in the context of the text?

- A) Called for help
- B) Brought out
- C) Destroyed
- D) Hidden
- **Correct Answer: B**

Assertion–Reason Questions

11. **Assertion (A):** Traditional hand fans are no longer used primarily for cooling in modern households.

Reason (R): The advent of technology like electric ceiling fans and air conditioners shifted their role to the cultural, decorative, and ritualistic sphere.

- A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- C) A is true, but R is false.

- D) A is false, but R is true.
- **Correct Answer: A**

12. Assertion (A): The poem 'Canvas of Soil' serves as an allegory.

Reason (R): It uses the physical act of cultivating a garden to represent human potential and life's journey.

- A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- C) A is true, but R is false.
- D) A is false, but R is true.
- **Correct Answer: A**

13. Assertion (A): The poet uses the word 'still' as a dual-meaning device.

Reason (R): It refers to both a motionless visual painting and the persistence of natural beauty over time.

- A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- C) A is true, but R is false.
- D) A is false, but R is true.
- **Correct Answer: A**

14. Assertion (A): Gujarat's Pankhas are primarily crafted using white ink on red backgrounds.

Reason (R): Geometrical patterns using white ink on red backgrounds are characteristic of tribal region designs rather than Gujarati mirror-work fans.

- A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- C) A is false, but R is true.
- D) A is true, but R is false.
- **Correct Answer: C** (*Assertion is false; Gujarat fans feature mirror work, cotton, and beads*)

15. **Assertion (A):** The transition of the Pankha from a utility object to a handicraft has economically empowered rural craftspeople.

Reason (R): Government initiatives and commercial workshops provide market platforms and sustainable livelihoods for artisans.

- A) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- C) A is true, but R is false.
- D) A is false, but R is true.
- **Correct Answer: A**